Karen Dettmar

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST · DESIGN ENGINEER · NEW YORK CITY

karen.dettmar@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kdettmar · karendettmar.com

Designer and front-end engineer with roughly seven years building production interfaces at the intersection of design and code. I hand-write HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, work in React and TypeScript, and prototype in code rather than argue about a mockup. Most of that time has been spent on the seam between design and engineering, four and a half years of it inside the developer platforms at Wix and Intuit, designing and building the tools, interfaces and documentation that both sides shipped from. Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex are core to how I work.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Engineering	TypeScript, JavaScript, React, React Native, Vue, Next.js, Astro, HTML5, CSS3, SASS, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, PHP, Ruby, Canvas animation, Three.js and WebGL, responsive layouts, component architecture, WCAG and ADA accessibility, REST APIs, Git
Design	Figma, Sketch, design systems, prototyping in code, wireframing, low and hi-fi prototypes, visual and brand systems, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects
Research	User calls, user personas, contextual inquiry, information architecture, usability testing, beta testing, QA
AI	Claude API, prompt design, structured output design, LLM integration, Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Midjourney
Platforms	WordPress, Webflow, Wix, Shopify and Liquid, Contentful, LEMP stack

EXPERIENCE

Independent Design Engineering New York, NY Jan 2026 – Current

- Designing and building interactive web tools in **TypeScript, Astro, Three.js, WebGL and Canvas**, from concept through deployment, including real-time graphics and generative pattern systems.

Developer Advocate INTUIT New York, NY Nov 2022 – Sept 2024

- Designed and built the scorecard, leaderboard, and reporting interface in **React** for the InnerSource Tournament, a readiness program spanning documentation standards and code coverage across the AI and Data business units. **Result: 150 participants, and 40% of the services scored became ready for other teams to adopt on their own.**
- Built and shipped engineer-facing tools and interactive learning experiences used by **7,000+ global employees**, owning the full development lifecycle from prototype through public deployment.
- Redesigned and implemented Intuit's external-facing open source website.
- Delivered internal training on React Security, InnerSource, OpenSource, **Design Systems,** and documentation standards, including the design systems session in new-employee onboarding.
- Wrote a conference talk on **accessibility, WCAG and ADA compliance**, accepted at **All Things Open**.

Developer Advocate WIX New York, NY Feb 2020 – Oct 2022

- Built the demo product for the first ever **Wix DevCon** from scratch, on several platform services that had not yet shipped, carrying it through prototyping, QA, and approvals with PMs, engineers, marketing, and the CEO against a fixed launch date it had to work on live. Delivered the keynote presenting it. **Result:** a community that started at 10 developers became a 300-person live keynote audience, and the demo build surfaced and fixed platform bugs.
- Designed and ran a user study assessing developer experience on the platform. **Findings drove product, R&D, and UX to ship onboarding UI updates, refreshed documentation, and new product features.**

- Established the first NYC Wix meetups where no local community existed. **Result: 8 attendees at the first meetup to 16 repeat attendees monthly.**
- Taught workshops on JavaScript fundamentals, UI/UX best practice, and design-to-code transitions, including a workshop that took college design students through their portfolio finals.

Front End Developer WET DESIGN Burbank, CA Feb 2019 – Jul 2019

- Redesigned and deployed the company intranet, consulting with the branding team on interface and technical requirements to make it the primary channel for company communication. Built and **usability tested** its components in Confluence, CSS, and JavaScript. **Result: 25% increase in time on page.**
- Built an internal travel management application: researched, wireframed, **usability tested**, and coded a **responsive, mobile-friendly single-page app** in VueJS, JavaScript, HTML, and SASS, defining user flow and data structure to the travel manager's requirements. **Result: replaced and retired the deprecated legacy system.**
- Maintained, updated, and built **mobile modular components** for the existing site.

Head Designer, Print and Web PIXOMONDO (PXO) Los Angeles, CA Jan 2018 – Jan 2019

- Redesigned and implemented the company website, meeting regularly with the CEO on design direction. Built on a **LEMP stack (CentOS, NGINX, MySQL, PHP)** with a **WordPress theme written from scratch. Result: 10% increase in page visits**, and the redesign was what made the campaign launch on schedule.
- Produced monthly print and digital campaigns around studio releases, including advertisements published in **Cinefex** and **Variety**, with accompanying hero image updates and blog posts.
- Built a **Raspberry Pi conference room booking system** for the studio.

Jr Front End Developer and Designer CIBT Washington, D.C. Jan 2017 – Nov 2017

- Maintained and redesigned components for multilingual company sites, providing bespoke landing pages for high-profile corporate clients (**Microsoft, Apple, IBM**) alongside the consumer-facing traveler experience.
- Built **clean, scalable, responsive templates** by hand in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, built to **WCAG** standards.
- Worked closely with the Digital Media Manager to design, create, deploy, and QA corporate sites across regions, serving as the defining document for corporate brand and company culture.

EDUCATION

Certification in Fashion Design
Parsons School of Design – The New School · Full-time 2025

Sewing & Garment Construction
Fashion Institute of Technology (FIT)

Full Stack Web Development Program: MEAN, Ruby on Rails, Python & Django
Coding Dojo · Washington, D.C.

B.A. Studio Art (Printmaking) · B.A. Politics (Foreign Affairs)
University of Virginia